

Did you know

Flex applications can be written using Adobe Flash Builder or by using the freely available Flex compiler from Adobe

Additional Skills

Understanding of browsers, C++, CSS, XML, JavaScript, various APIs will help you excel in Flash development

Work@tech

Careers in Flash

The demand for good Flash developers is going sky high, while the scarcity is driving up salaries considerably. There couldn't be a better time to look at it as a viable career option

film, television, or even advertising who use Flash for storyboarding and advertising companies that use it for creating rich media interactive banners. In the current scenario the digital content designer is in the next stage of evolution. Such designers will eventually have capabilities to create content in Print, Web and Mobile as well. "In the future I don't see companies hiring print, web and mobile designers separately," said Himanshu. "These next generation designers will be able to service any of these segments".

Then there's the programming-heavy development side of Flash that entails everything from RIAs (Rich Internet Applications) and Web Development to Gaming, to eLearning and Enterprise Level applications. Gaming companies leverage it for casual as well as high end MMORPGs games, while at the enterprise level there are consulting companies such as Accenture and Deloitte besides system integration companies such as Wipro and Infosys that use Flex to build solutions for their customers. These streams are not mutually exclusive. There are a lot of overlaps and that's where things start to get interesting.

When it was just Flash, good interactive programmers or developers stayed a little shy off it, because the environment was not supportive of the best programming practices that were available in some of the other tools like Java. With the inclusion of Adobe Flex and other tools it transformed into a true platform for creating some of the most robust apps complete with interactivity, business logic, server side communication, data linkages *et al.* The best of the programmers got attracted to Flash and because everyone wanted to have rich, good looking interfaces for their applications the natural progression was to go with Adobe Flash. The programming side evolved with time to an object oriented approach, starting with Actionscript 1.0 to now Actionscript 3.0. A lot of flexibility was added for development of widgets as well.



SOURCE: FLASH PLATFORM SUMMIT

Siddharth Parwatay
siddharth.parwatay@thinkdigit.com

When someone talks about Flash what is the first thing that comes to your mind? Our guess would be "moving images, animation, and Flashy Stuff". If your thoughts hover in that area, you're not wrong but you're not completely right either. In reality, Flash has now grown from a mere animation tool that it was, into a platform. The word platform is being thrown about loosely these days, so we'll come to that in a bit and explain what makes Flash a platform. But first, let's take a step back and understand how Flash has evolved. "Initially when Flash started off as an animation tool, people looked at it simply as something that can help creating animations for the web – things like banners and ads. But there's a huge interactive angle to it that made the adoption of Flash so rampant," says Himanshu Mody, CEO Tekno Point Multimedia, one of the leading Flash Training institutes in the country. Speaking of adoption, a 2008 survey by Research & Markets, Ireland pegged the software

developer workforce in India at 1.7 million developers and projected a growth of 25 per cent by 2010. Though impressive by itself, the actual figures may have gone way above the now dated projections.

Lay of the land

At the very broad level we can classify two distinct streams that Flash allows you to pursue in terms of a career. There's the creative side involving design, that's now increasingly being termed as Digital Content Creation. "For a designer it's always Photoshop first. Then we take our design, import it in Flash and bring it to life. Flash gives you the ability to bring motion into still images and that's what attracted me. It gives your website/animation/movie a sleekness. That's how I started out", says Abhilash Krishnan, Creative Director, UFO Digital. You have story telling mediums like



"Though industry requires professionals with certifications it also gives importance to individuals with strong portfolios. So it would be good for budding enthusiasts to work on creating their portfolios while studying Flash"

Abhilash Krishnan, Creative Director, UFO Digital